

AETHER WIRELESS · KNOWLEDGE BASE

SIM Replacement Policy

Category B — Policy & Process Knowledge Base

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Overview

This document outlines the policies and procedures for issuing SIM card replacements—including physical SIMs and eSIMs—to existing Aether Wireless customers. It covers eligibility criteria, replacement timelines, fees, identity verification requirements, and the process for handling lost or stolen SIMs. All replacement SIMs retain the customer's existing phone number and service plan.

Section 1: When a SIM Replacement Is Required

A SIM replacement is available when any of the following conditions apply:

- **Lost SIM:** The SIM card has been misplaced and is unrecoverable.
- **Stolen SIM:** The SIM card was taken as part of a device theft.
- **Damaged SIM:** The SIM card is physically damaged, warped, or unreadable due to wear, water exposure, or tampering.
- **New Device:** The customer is activating a device that requires a different SIM form factor (e.g., moving from a standard SIM to a nano-SIM, or from physical SIM to eSIM).
- **eSIM Upgrade:** The customer wishes to convert from a physical SIM to an embedded SIM (eSIM) for convenience or to utilize dual-SIM functionality.
- **SIM Not Detected:** The device fails to recognize the SIM after troubleshooting, and the SIM is confirmed defective.

Section 2: Replacement Fees and Eligibility

Free Replacement Window

A SIM replacement is provided at **no charge** when requested within **14 days of the original line activation date**. This applies to first-time replacements only and covers the cost of the SIM card itself.

Standard Replacement Fee

After the 14-day window, a **\$10 replacement fee** applies per SIM card. This fee is charged to the customer's account upon issuance of the replacement SIM.

Fee Exceptions

The \$10 fee may be waived at customer service discretion in the following cases:

- The original SIM was defective upon delivery (confirmed via troubleshooting)
- The replacement is required due to a manufacturer hardware defect
- The customer is upgrading to eSIM as part of a promoted migration offer

Section 3: Replacement Options and Delivery Times

In-Store Replacement

Customers may visit any Aether Wireless retail location for immediate SIM replacement.

- **Processing time:** Up to **10 minutes** per SIM
- **Availability:** During standard store hours
- **Note:** Customers should call ahead to confirm SIM inventory for their specific device type

Shipped Delivery

If visiting a store is not convenient, customers may request shipment of a physical SIM.

- **Delivery timeframe:** **2 business days** from the time the request is processed
- **Shipping method:** Standard ground shipping at no additional cost
- **Tracking:** A tracking number is sent via SMS or email once the SIM ships

eSIM Re-Issuance (Digital Delivery)

For customers with eSIM-compatible devices, a replacement eSIM can be issued digitally without needing a physical card.

- **Delivery methods:** Via the Aether Wireless app or by email with a QR code
- **Processing time:** Within **minutes** of verification approval
- **Activation:** The customer scans the QR code or follows in-app prompts to transfer the eSIM to their device

Section 4: eSIM Compatibility

Only devices with embedded SIM capability can receive an eSIM replacement. Customers must confirm their device is on the approved list before requesting an eSIM.

Compatible Device Models

Device Brand	Minimum Model Required
Apple	iPhone XS, iPhone XS Max, iPhone XR, and later
Samsung	Galaxy S20 series and later
Google	Pixel 3, Pixel 3 XL, and later

Additional compatible devices may be added over time. Customers can verify compatibility via the Aether Wireless app or by speaking with a customer service representative.

Section 5: Dual-SIM Functionality

Customers with compatible devices may maintain **two active SIMs** (one physical and one eSIM) simultaneously, allowing:

- Use of two different phone numbers on one device
- Separation of personal and business lines
- Domestic and international number handling

To activate dual-SIM, customers must request a second SIM or eSIM for their existing line. A second \$10 replacement fee applies if the customer is outside the free replacement window.

Section 6: Identity Verification Requirements

To protect customer accounts and prevent unauthorized SIM swaps, **two-factor identity verification** is required before any SIM replacement is issued.

Verification Factors

Customers must provide **both** of the following:

1. **Device IMEI Number:** The International Mobile Equipment Identity number of the device the SIM will be used in. Customers can retrieve this by dialing *#06# on their device.
2. **Government-Issued ID:** A valid, unexpired photo ID such as a driver's license, state ID, passport, or military ID.

Verification Methods

- **In-Store:** Staff verify the ID and cross-reference the IMEI provided by the customer against the device presented.
 - **Online/App:** Customers upload a photo of their ID and enter their device IMEI through the Aether Wireless app or website.
 - **Phone:** A customer care representative verifies the ID by requesting the customer read or spell certain ID fields; the IMEI must be provided via the app or entered during the call.
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Section 7: Lost or Stolen SIM Handling

Immediate Blocking

Customers who report a lost or stolen SIM should request an immediate block to prevent unauthorized usage. The Aether Wireless **24/7 hotline** is available for this purpose.

- **Hotline number:** 1-800-555-0199 (available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week)
- **Block activation:** Immediate upon customer request
- **Account security:** The customer's number and plan remain intact; service is suspended until a replacement SIM is activated

Replacement After Blocking

Once a SIM is blocked, the customer may request a replacement:

- A new SIM (physical or eSIM) is issued following standard replacement procedures
 - The \$10 fee applies if outside the 14-day activation window
 - The customer's original phone number is preserved
 - Service is restored once the new SIM is activated on the line
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Section 8: What Remains Unchanged

When a SIM replacement is processed, the following account elements **do not change**:

- **Phone number:** The existing number is ported to the new SIM
 - **Service plan:** The current rate plan, including data allowances, minutes, and features, remains in effect
 - **Account billing details:** Billing information and payment methods are unchanged
 - **Device financing:** Any device installment agreements remain attached to the line
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FAQs

Q: How long does it take to get a replacement SIM in the mail?

A: Shipped SIMs typically arrive within 2 business days from the time the order is processed. You will receive a tracking number via SMS or email once the SIM ships.

Q: Can I get a replacement SIM if I'm traveling internationally?

A: Yes. International customers can request an eSIM for immediate digital delivery or a physical SIM shipped to their international address. Additional shipping fees may apply for international delivery. Contact customer service for specific options.

Q: Will I lose my contacts or data if I get a new SIM?

A: No. Contacts and data stored on your device are unaffected by a SIM replacement. However, any contacts saved only to the SIM card itself (rather than the device memory or cloud) will not transfer. We recommend backing up device contacts to cloud storage before replacing the SIM.

Q: What happens if I lose my SIM while traveling and need an emergency replacement?

A: Call the 24/7 hotline at 1-800-555-0199 to block the lost SIM immediately. For urgent needs, an eSIM can be issued within minutes to a compatible device, allowing you to restore service quickly without waiting for a physical card to be shipped.

Q: Can I keep my physical SIM and also add an eSIM to the same line?

A: Yes, if your device supports dual-SIM functionality. You may have one physical SIM and one eSIM active on the same line simultaneously. This allows you to use two numbers on a single device.

Q: What ID do I need to provide for a SIM replacement?

A: You must present a valid, government-issued photo ID (such as a driver's license, state ID, or passport) and provide the IMEI number of the device where the replacement SIM will be used.

For assistance with SIM replacements, visit your nearest Aether Wireless store, use the Aether Wireless app, or call 1-800-555-0199.